

大学英语阅读 · READING

The Weight of Choices

Paragraph 3 · 精读展示

GROUP 3

6 MIN



原文呈现 · Original Text

Paragraph 3 — ①–⑤ 句编号，供后文引用。

①Perhaps the most **daunting** challenge for a freshman is the **sheer** number of choices that lie ahead. ②Choosing a major, deciding on minors, joining clubs, applying for internships, and even picking a career path — all these decisions **press down on** an 18-year-old who, just a year ago, was mainly concerned with passing high school exams. ③Many students fall into a **paralysis of analysis**, spending hours weighing pros and cons but never making a decision. ④Others rush into choices **impulsively**, only to regret them later. ⑤The question *'What do I want to do with my life?'* becomes a constant companion, whispering in moments of quiet and screaming in moments of panic.

① 划出生词

Underline new words

② 找出核心问句

Find the core question

③ 找出两种反应

Spot the two reactions

重点词汇 · Key Vocabulary

daunting /'daɪntɪŋ/ adj.

令人畏惧的；使人气馁的

Starting college can feel daunting at first.

搭配：a daunting task / challenge
/ prospect； find sth daunting

sheer /ʃɪr/ adj.

（强调数量 / 程度）十足的；纯粹的

The sheer number of choices overwhelmed her.

搭配：sheer number / size / scale
/ volume / joy

impulsively /ɪm'pʌlsɪvli/
adv.

冲动地；凭一时冲动

He impulsively signed up for five clubs.

搭配：act / decide / buy / react
impulsively

重点词汇 · Traps & Pressures

paralysis of analysis *n. phr.*

「分析瘫痪」——想太多，反而做不了决定

Trapped in paralysis of analysis, she never chose.

搭配: fall into / be stuck in / suffer from

press down on *v. phr.*

压在...上；给...施加压力

All these decisions press down on an 18-year-old.

近义: weigh on / bear down on / burden

词汇拓展 · Word Family

impulse →
impulsive →
impulsively

冲动 (n.) → 冲动的
(adj.) → 冲动地 (adv.)

daunt → daunting
→ undaunted

使胆怯 (v.) → 令人生畏的 (adj.) → 无畏的 (adj.)

长难句解析 · The List of Choices

原句

Choosing a major, deciding on minors, joining clubs, applying for internships, and even picking a career path — all these decisions press down on an 18-year-old who, just a year ago, was mainly concerned with passing high school exams.

句子结构

→ 五个并列 **V-ing** (列举): Choosing / deciding / joining / applying / picking

→ 谓语 press down on + 宾语 an 18-year-old

修辞 · 排比 Accumulation

五个动作层层叠加，把选择的"重量"一并压给读者，制造扑面而来的压迫感。

参考译文

选专业、定辅修、加社团、申实习，甚至规划职业道路——所有这些决定，一股脑压在一个 18 岁的人身上；而仅仅一年前，他操心的还只是能不能通过高中考试。

→ 破折号 总结上文 → 主语 **all these decisions**

→ 定语从句 who...修饰 an 18-year-old

长难句解析 · The Question That Never Leaves

原句

The question *'What do I want to do with my life?'* **becomes a constant companion**, whispering in moments of quiet and screaming in moments of panic.

句子结构

🗨️ **WHISPER** · 低语

whispering in moments of quiet

安静时，它在耳边轻声低语。

朗读：轻、慢

😱 **SCREAM** · 尖叫

screaming in moments of panic

慌乱时，它在脑中放声尖叫。

朗读：重、响

📄 修辞手法

拟人 **Personification** (把"问题"写成会低语、会尖叫的人) +
对照 **Antithesis** (quiet ↔ panic, whisper ↔ scream)

01

主干：The question becomes a companion (主系表)

02

同位语：'What...life?' 解释 the question

03

伴随状语：whispering... / screaming... (现在分词短语)

主旨与作用 · Main Idea & Function

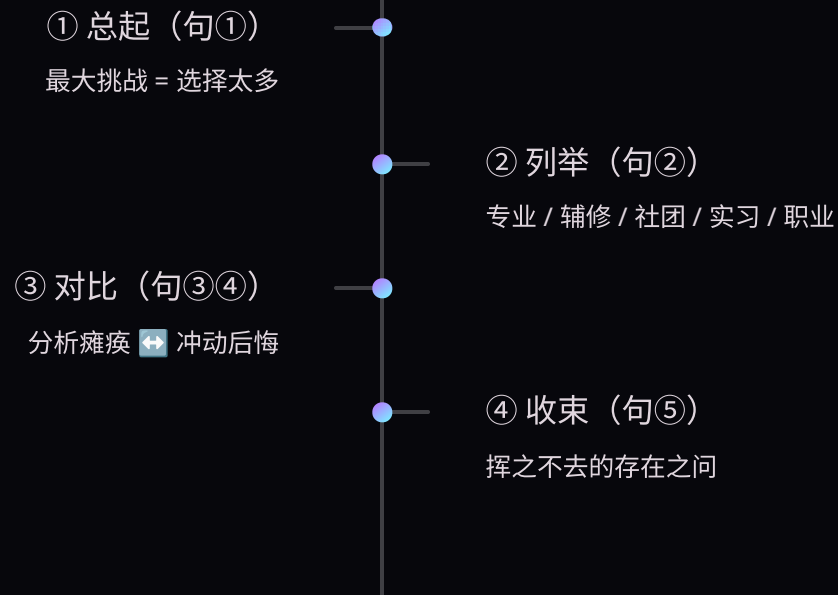
主旨 Main Idea

For an overwhelmed freshman, endless choices breed two opposite failures — hesitation and haste — and a question that never leaves.

面对扑面而来的选择，迷茫的大一新生容易走向两个极端——要么无止境犹豫，要么鲁莽冲动；而“我到底想做什么”，始终挥之不去。

写作手法

段落脉络 Flow



在全文中的作用 Function

- 承上：延续前文“新生适应挑战”，聚焦到“选择”
- 展开：用具体决策 + 两种反应，把抽象焦虑写实
- 启下：抛出“人生方向”之问，引向后文

排比 Parallelism

对比 Antithesis

拟人 Personification

课堂讨论 · Which Trap Catches You?

Which trap catches you more — paralysis of analysis or impulsive decisions?

你更容易掉进哪个陷阱——"分析瘫痪", 还是"冲动决定"?

← 分析瘫痪型

Analysis paralysis · 更犹豫

看情况

Depends

冲动型 →

Impulsive · 更冲动

📝 语言支架 Language Support

发言时至少用上这 3 个词: **daunting** · **paralysis of analysis** · **impulsively**

参考句式: *I tend to ___, so I'm more of a(n) ___. For example, ___.*

Q2 (备选) If you could send one message back to your first-month self, what would you rethink?

如果能给开学第一个月的自己带句话, 你会重新想清楚什么?

Naming the trap is the first step out of it.

看清陷阱，就是走出它的第一步。

今日词汇回顾 · Today's 5 Words

daunting

sheer

impulsively

paralysis of analysis

press down on

Thank You · Questions Welcome

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